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a CRITERION GAME

SKOAR!

The Most Wanted Arcade racer

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Let's get one thing straight, despite anything else that we might say further on, Most Wanted is probably the most fun racing gaming we've played in a long time. Criterion have, at the very least, done one thing right and have managed to do exactly what is expected from any game studio, create a game that is an absolute blast to play. What Criterion have done is that they've taken every NFS title since the original Most Wanted, stripped them of (almost) all their shortcomings, taken the best features of every game, and cohesively merged and enhanced them into one game to create Most Wanted.

The game has no narrative or story and doesn't even pretend to have one. You're given a car, given 10 targets, and then let loose on the road to have fun, race, wreak havoc; whatever takes your fancy. There are over a hundred cars scattered throughout the world and you can drive up to any one of them and take them for a spin. You're not restricted to

any car and if you find it, it's yours. There is no more of that hierarchy where you go from bad cars to better cars to superlative cars. Each car has about six races specifically tailored for its type and you can have fun, competitive racing with any car you like and find. This focus on pure arcade-style fun even extends to the cut-scenes; every race has an intro that is, from an aesthetic and design stand-point, really cool. They're not realistic, you'll see cars floating in the air, or emerging like a growing crystals and it just looks fantastic.

There is a lot to do in this world. Racing past speed cams chalks your name up on a leader board that you and your friends can see and compete against, the same goes for the hoardings that you smash. What sets this game apart from the previous game is the socializing that goes into it. Seeing your friends smash one of your speed records would want you to pick yourself up and take back what's yours.

In fact, multiplayer is where this game shines. This is a game needs to be experienced online and while the single-player is fun, it just isn't what this game is all about. ★

Verdict

The game is not pretending to be something it isn't and Criterion have done a superb job in polishing this title and making sure that the game is fun. Most Wanted is bucket loads of fun. It is a very polished game that looks gorgeous and plays well. There are very few games that can fulfil your need for speed the way this game does.

MOAR!

- » **Genre:** Racing
- » **Developer:** Criterion Games
- » **Publisher:** Electronic Arts
- » **Price:** PS3, Xbox 360 (NA); PC (₹1,499)





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